30-DAY GIT LEARNING SERIES

GIT QUEST

LEVEL 8

WEEK 2 BEGINS!

.gitignore: The Do-Not-Pack List

Week 2: Undo and Branch | Absolute Beginner

QUEST PROGRESS: DAY 8 OF 30

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The Story: The Do-Not-Pack List

Commit the Cat is about to ship a parcel. Wait, not that file!

1

Oops

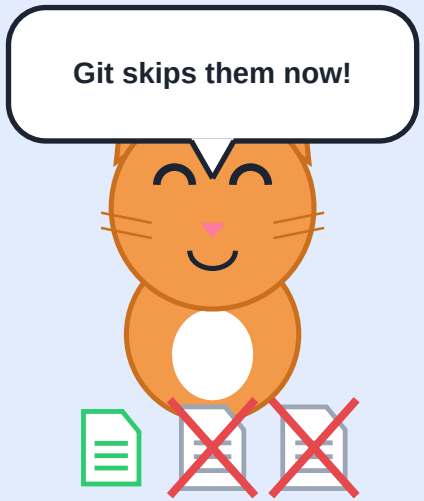
Passwords, logs and junk files have no place in a shared project.

2

The list

.gitignore is a plain text file. Write one pattern per line.

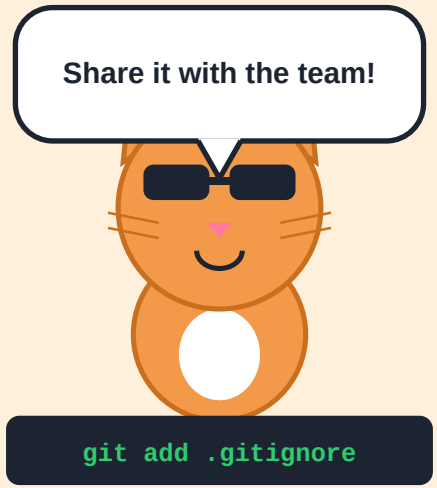
3



Skipped

Matching files vanish from git status and git add . leaves them alone.

4



Commit it

Commit .gitignore itself so everyone follows the same rules.

Writing Your Do-Not-Pack List

One pattern per line. Git does the rest.

A SAMPLE .gitignore

```
# Secrets
secret.txt
.env
# Logs
*.log
# Build output
build/
node_modules/
# System junk
.DS_Store
```

PATTERN CHEAT SHEET

`secret.txt`	Exactly that file
`*.log`	Every file ending in .log
`build/`	The whole build folder
`/todo.txt`	Only the top-level todo.txt
`!keep.log`	Exception: track this one
`# note`	A comment for humans

WHAT SHOULD YOU IGNORE?

Secrets	Build output	Logs and temp	System files
`passwords, .env, keys`	`build/, dist/, node_modules/`	`*.log, *.tmp`	`.DS_Store, Thumbs.db, .vscode/`

GOTCHA

Ignoring only works on files Git is NOT tracking yet. Already committed?
Run `git rm --cached <file>` to stop tracking it (the file stays on your disk).

Ignore it BEFORE you commit it!

Quest Board: Build Your List

Finish 4 quests, then collect today's commit.

1 Make a lab with some junk

```
$ git init -b main ignore-lab && cd ignore-lab
$ echo "My notes" > notes.txt
$ echo "password=1234" > secret.txt
$ echo "debug" > app.log
$ mkdir build && echo "out" > build/result.txt
```

2 See the mess

```
$ git status
```

4 untracked items, including secret.txt!

3 Write the Do-Not-Pack list

```
$ printf "secret.txt\n*.log\nbuild/\n" > .gitignore
$ git status
```

secret.txt, app.log and build/ vanish!

4 Commit it, then peek at ignored

```
$ git add . && git commit -m "Add notes and .gitignore"
$ git status --ignored
```

LOOT: TODAY'S COMMIT

COMMIT

days-1-to-8-summary.md

```
docs(day08): add days 1-8 summary and gitignore notes
```

Recap of Days 1 to 8 plus gitignore notes.

SIDE QUEST: ALREADY TRACKED?

```
$ git rm --cached scratch.txt
$ git commit -m "Stop tracking scratch.txt"
```

The file stays on your disk.

DETECTIVE TOOL

```
$ git check-ignore -v app.log
.gitignore:2:*.log   app.log
```

Which rule is hiding this file?

Boss Fight and Bonus Loot

Cheat sheet, starter list, quiz and your next unlock.

BONUS 1: DAY 8 CHEAT SHEET

```
echo "*.log" >> .gitignore    Add a rule
git status --ignored          Show ignored files too
git check-ignore -v <file>    Which rule ignores it?
git rm --cached <file>        Stop tracking, keep file
git add .gitignore            Share the rules
```

BONUS 2: A STARTER .gitignore

```
.DS_Store
Thumbs.db
*.log
.env
node_modules/
.vscode/
```

BONUS 3: READY-MADE TEMPLATES

```
github.com/github/gitignore
(one ready-made list for every language)
```

BOSS FIGHT: QUICK QUIZ

1. What does *.log match?
2. You ignored a file but Git still tracks it. How do you fix that?
3. Which kind of file should you never commit?

Answers: 1) Every file ending in .log 2) git rm --cached <file>, then commit 3) Passwords, keys and .env secrets

CHALLENGE

Create .DS_Store and notes.tmp. Write two rules so Git ignores both, then prove it with git status --ignored.

LEVEL 9: git restore and git reset

Unlocks tomorrow. Oops! Learn to take back mistakes safely.

LOCKED